



SANDARC VEC Manual

Volunteer Examiner Manual

San Diego County Amateur Radio Council · Volunteer Examiner Coordinator

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vec.sandarc.org/manual

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Intro

Being A Cool VE

A few Requirements the FCC imposes on becoming a Volunteer Examiner:

- Must be at least 18 years old
- Never have had your amateur station or operator licenses suspended or revoked
- Hold a valid General, Advanced or Extra Class license

A requirement that SANDARC imposes on you becoming a VE:

- Be cool

Becoming Accredited

- Accreditation can only be attained through Team Leads and will not be done on a per-person basis.

Checking Accreditation

- Once your Team Lead has submitted your VE application it will be processed within 24 hrs or your next accreditation is free!
- You will receive an email from SANDARC with the accreditation certificate attached.
- At the bottom of that certificate is a verification link if you paste that into a browser you will confirm your accreditation is valid, each url is unique to each VE.

Maintaining Accreditation

- Once you have become accredited you will be for as long as your license is active however you will only maintain access to [ExamTools](#) if you have participated in an exam every 2 years and once that two years has passed you will lose access and will need to reach back out to your team lead to regain access again.

SANDARC VE Badges

- In your accreditation email will be a link to order a badge but please note a badge is NOT required to participate in any VE session!

Key Contacts & Resources

SANDARC VEC

RESOURCE	CONTACT / URL
SANDARC VEC General Contact	vec@sandarc.org
New VE Applications	Submit through your Team Lead to vec@sandarc.org
New Team Inquiries	vec@sandarc.org
Session Submissions	VEC Archive file via email to vec@sandarc.org
SANDARC Website	sandarc.org

FCC & Exam Platform Resources

RESOURCE	CONTACT / URL
FCC Universal Licensing System (ULS)	fcc.gov/wireless/universal-licensing-system
FCC CORES (FRN Registration)	apps.fcc.gov/cores/userLogin.do
FCC \$35 Application Fee Payment	apps.fcc.gov/cores/paymentFrnLogin.do
ExamTools (Session Platform)	exam.tools
HamStudy (Session Calendar & Applicant Registration)	hamstudy.org/sessions
FCC Electronic CFR: Part 97 (Amateur Radio Service)	ecfr.gov : 47 CFR Part 97

Working with Other VECs

Teams are free to work with other VECs in addition to SANDARC. However, please be mindful of the following circumstances:

Scheduling Sessions Under Multiple VECs at the Same Time

There is no benefit in running one session under multiple VECs. Please decide which VEC your team is affiliated with, and stick with it. Scheduling sessions on top of each other will just pollute the HamStudy listing and ultimately confuse applicants.

NOTE

The only exception is when the other VEC reimburses students/youths for their FCC application fee. Still, you should hide the other session to avoid creating duplicate sessions on the HamStudy listing.

SANDARC reserves the right to take action against teams who run concurrent sessions, a single session under multiple VECs, spreading applicants across multiple sessions, or employing other *innovative means to game the system*.

Branding and Publications

No branding of any other VECs is permitted at SANDARC exam sessions. You are, however, encouraged to use your club logo and slogan at the exam sessions and promote your club.

Prepare For A Session

Preparing for the Session

ExamTools: Required Platform

SANDARC POLICY

ExamTools is the **ONLY** authorized platform for generating and administering exams at SANDARC sessions. No other exam software, printed materials from outside sources, or manually created exams may be used under any circumstances. All exam content — whether delivered on a tablet, computer, or printed via GradeCam — must originate from ExamTools.

Any deviation from this requirement must receive explicit prior written approval from the SANDARC VEC Manager. Sessions conducted outside of ExamTools without that approval will NOT be processed.

ExamTools handles applicant registration, Form 605 generation, exam delivery (tablet, computer, or printed/GradeCam), grading, CSCE generation, and the session archive file that is submitted to SANDARC after the session.

- Team Leads: create your session at <https://exam.tools>
- Applicants register and complete their application through HamStudy (hamstudy.org/sessions)

ExamTools supports three in-person exam formats:

- **Tablet/laptop:** applicants log in and take the exam in a browser; preferred method. Tablets locked to the ExamTools site are strongly recommended.
- **Printed/GradeCam:** exams printed from ExamTools, graded by photographing the answer sheet with the GradeCam feature.

- **Hybrid:** some applicants use tablets, others use printed exams in the same session.

Test Site Requirements

- The testing environment **MUST** be quiet and free from distractions. Make every effort to keep non-participants out of the exam area while testing is in progress.
- If applicants completing paperwork after the exam are in the same room as applicants still testing, all post-exam activity **MUST** be conducted as quietly as possible.
- Suitable locations include schools, libraries, community centers, fire stations, and club meeting rooms.

Session Day Quick Reference Checklist

San Diego County Amateur Radio Council | The Coolest VEC | vec@sandarc.org

Before Candidates Arrive

- ✓ Confirm all VEs present are SANDARC-accredited (check with Team Lead if unsure)
- ✓ **ExamTools** session created and accessible
- ✓ Scratch paper, pencils, calculators - if available (memories cleared)
- ✓ Testing area quiet and free from distractions; non-participants cleared from the area
- ✓ **NO recording equipment active:** all recording is prohibited at SANDARC sessions (promotional photos are the one exception; never of IDs, forms, or exam screens)
- ✓ No other VEC branding visible at the session location

Candidate Check-In

- ✓ Greet each applicant warmly
- ✓ Verify photo ID: do not write down any numbers from the ID; do not photograph or video the ID
- ✓ For minors without photo ID: parent or guardian may verify identity
- ✓ Review any element credit documents: make a copy, return originals
- ✓ Add applicant to **ExamTools** roster
- ✓ Remind applicant: SANDARC charges no exam fee, but the FCC charges a separate \$35 fee after submission of any new license!

During the Exam

- ✓ Announce session policies to all applicants before exams begin

- ✓ Issue exam via [ExamTools](#) (tablet, computer, or printed)
- ✓ At least 3 VEs observing all candidates at all times; stop all testing if team drops below 3
- ✓ VEs not reading, or having unnecessary conversations
- ✓ **No recording of any kind**, including screen capture; promotional photos only, never showing IDs, forms, or exam screens
- ✓ Grade each element immediately after completion; inform applicant of score
- ✓ If passed: allow applicant to attempt next element if desired or whatever the team policy is
- ✓ Take the applicant through signing their CSCE and confirming all information is accurate
- ✓ Advise upgrading applicants about temporary identifier (/AG, /AE)
- ✓ Advise new licensees they cannot transmit until a license appears in FCC ULS

After the Last Candidate Leaves

- ✓ Finalize session in [ExamTools](#); download VEC Archive file (DO NOT OPEN THE ARCHIVE ONCE DOWNLOADED)
- ✓ Email VEC Archive file and supporting documents to vec@sandarc.org
- ✓ Retain your copy of all session records until SANDARC confirms processing
- ✓ Brief the team on what went well and what to improve for next time

Exam Materials

[ExamTools](#) is the only authorized source for generating question booklets, NCVEC Form 605, and CSCE. SANDARC does not supply any of the above and prohibits the use of materials acquired from other sources.

Exam Booklets

Team Leads can print Exam booklets directly from [ExamTools](#). Please make sure you download exams that are suited for GradeCam™ use. SANDARC does not allow manual grading or pre-determined keys.

Re-using Question Booklets

It is perfectly acceptable to reuse exams from one session across multiple sessions as long as you don't administer the same exam to an applicant more than once.

Bubble Forms (aka scantrons)

Use the 35/50 question combo form downloadable from [ExamTools](#)

You may optionally provide the [SANDARC instruction sheet](#) to your applicants to help them correctly complete the bubble sheet.

EXAM VALIDITY

The Question Pool Committee (QPC) may issue errata, which could invalidate some of the pre-printed exams. **It is crucial to ensure your exams are valid.** You will receive an email from SANDARC upon each new erratum. You can always check the validity of your exams by checking their test IDs on [ExamTools](#).

*You can optionally provide the [SANDARC instruction sheet](#) to your applicants, ensuring they understand how to fill out the bubble form.

Administering Exams on Tablets

Teams are encouraged to use tablets to administer exams. This way, you won't have to deal with invalidated exams and your applicants will always receive a perfectly valid and random set of questions. That being said, the team is responsible for properly locking down the device to ensure the applicants cannot gain any unfair advantage.

Use tablets if you can. It helps save some trees after all ~(^)/~

Form NCVEC 605

Form NCVEC 605 is automatically generated for each applicant via [ExamTools](#). Teams do not need to print nor fill out any physical form.

Certificate of Successful Completion of Examination (CSCE)

Similar to Form NCVEC 605, [ExamTools](#) will also handle generating CSCEs for you.

Registering Applicants

Creating Session on ExamTools

Once you have a set date and time for your session(s), you must create these sessions on [ExamTools](#). [ExamTools](#) will automatically list your sessions on HamStudy which is where applicants will find and register for your session.

[ExamTools](#) will give a handful of options to customize how your sessions are displayed on HamStudy. Please make use of these options to create a smooth user experience for your applicants.

KNOWN BUG

[ExamTools](#) sets the SANDARC session fee to `NaN` by default. This is a known bug. Please manually reset this field to `0`.

Please refer to [ExamTools Documentation](#) to learn more about scheduling your sessions on [ExamTools](#).

[ExamTools](#) in conjunction with HamStudy is the only authorized platform to register applicants. Teams are encouraged to use other appropriate means to advertise their sessions such as your club's website and local nets, in which case you should direct applicants to HamStudy to register for your session.

ARRL VEC Session Listing

A substantial number of applicants use the ARRL VEC Session listing to find local exam sessions. The ARRL VEC will list non-ARRL sessions on their website as a courtesy, and we encourage all teams to take advantage of this opportunity. All you need to do is submit a [session registration form](#) to the ARRL VEC. It is best to submit your team email along with this form and when applicants get in touch with you, please direct them to your session on HamStudy to complete their registration.

Registering Walk-in Applicants

If your team allows applicants to walk in, they should register similar to other applicants via HamStudy.

It is worth noting that there is a feature on [ExamTools](#) that allows you to bypass HamStudy and directly add applicants to your session. **Please refrain from using this feature unless under extenuating circumstances.** Applicants must complete the entirety of the registration process on HamStudy which entails agreeing to [ExamTools](#) ToS, providing personal info, which later will be used on their form NCVEC 605 and answering the felony question.

Conduct A Session

Conducting the Session

Applicant Check-In

- 1 Greet each applicant warmly. Many are nervous, so a friendly welcome goes a long way.
- 2 Verify photo identification. Acceptable forms include any government-issued photo ID (driver's license, passport, state ID card, military ID, etc.). For applicants under 18 who do not have a government-issued photo ID, a parent or guardian may present their own ID and confirm the applicant's identity.
- 3 Confirm the applicant's name on Form 605 matches their ID. For upgrades, confirm that the ID, existing license, and Form 605 all refer to the same person.
- 4 Confirm the FRN is present on Form 605 and that the applicant has answered the BQQ.
- 5 Review any element credit documents the applicant has brought. If element credit is required, update [ExamTools](#) with the credit.
- 6 Add the applicant to the [ExamTools](#) session roster.

NOTE

Do not write down any numbers from the applicant's ID. Do not photograph or video the ID. Examining both sides of a physical ID card is good practice, since some fraudulent IDs appear valid on the front but are blank on the back. If you do not feel comfortable with the ID presented, please let the team lead make the decision on whether to proceed with the applicant testing.

Element Credit

Applicants may receive credit for exam elements based on their current or former license class, or a valid CSCE from a previous session. The applicant is responsible for providing documentation, not the VE team.

APPLICANT'S LICENSE STATUS	CREDIT GIVEN
Unexpired Amateur Extra	Already holds that class; no new credit needed.
Unexpired General, Advanced, or Technician issued before 3/21/1987	Elements 2 & 3; must still pass Element 4 for Extra.
Expired Amateur Extra (beyond 2-year grace period)	Elements 3 & 4 credit; must still take and pass Element 2.
Expired General, Advanced, or pre-3/21/1987 Technician (beyond grace period)	Element 3 credit; must still take and pass Element 2.
Expired Technician Plus or Technician issued on/after 3/21/1987 (beyond grace period)	No credit.
Valid CSCE from a prior session (within 365 days)	Credit for elements shown on the CSCE.

NOTE

A CSCE is valid for element credit for 365 days from the date it was issued, or until the FCC updates the applicant's ULS record, whichever comes first. The applicant must present the original CSCE. Photocopies are generally not acceptable.

Acceptable Documents for Element Credit

- Current unexpired FCC amateur license (or ULS reference copy)

- Expired FCC license copy, or a ULS reference copy or screenshot showing the expired license record
- FCC License Verification Letter (for older records not in the online ULS)
- Radio Amateur Callbook listing (Fall 1967 or later editions show license class)
- CSCE from a prior VE session, issued within the last 365 days

Session Announcements

At the start of each session, inform all applicants of the following:

- Retest policy (VE team's discretion; see Retesting below)
- Rules about leaving the exam room: once the exam has started, the applicant may not leave until all materials are turned in; leaving prematurely voids the exam
- Calculators must have memory cleared. Cell phones and smart devices may not be used as calculators.
- No written notes, books, or study materials in the exam area.
- Cell phones must be silenced or turned off.

During the Exam

- Issue the exam through [ExamTools](#) for tablet sessions. For printed exams, verify the applicant receives the correct element and exam version.
- At least three VEs must observe every candidate actively and continuously throughout the exam.
- VEs must NOT engage in unnecessary conversation during examinations. The most common complaint about exam sessions is unnecessary VE chatter, so please do not talk unless necessary and if it is necessary please talk quietly.
- Provide the next element exam only after the previous one has been graded and passed.

- VEs shall NOT authorize exams to applicants unless they have direct contact with that applicant!

IMPORTANT

All recording — including screen capture — is prohibited at SANDARC sessions, whether in-person or online. Do not record applicant IDs, exam screens, or any session activity.

The one exception: still photos for the promotion of SANDARC are welcome, provided they never capture personal information (IDs, Form 605s, exam screens, or answer sheets) and are never used to monitor applicants, document suspected cheating, or for any purpose other than promotion.

Grading

- **ExamTools** grades computerized exams automatically when the applicant clicks "Grade Exam" and a VE authorizes grading. For printed exams use GradeCam on **ExamTools**.
- Inform the applicant of their score (number correct out of total) promptly after grading. If the applicant asks which questions they missed, you may share/email the question identifier to them (e.g., T1E01).

Retesting

There is no mandatory waiting period before retaking a failed exam. Whether to allow an immediate retest is entirely at the VE team's discretion: it is the team's decision, not the applicant's right.

- An applicant may not be given the same exam version they previously failed. [§97.509(f)] **ExamTools** generates a new, unique exam automatically for retakes.
- The VE team should consider the applicant's score on the failed attempt and the team's remaining availability when deciding whether to allow a retest.

- If a retest is granted, the applicant continues under SANDARC's free-exam policy, so no additional fee is charged.

Cheating & Misconduct

- If cheating is suspected or observed, immediately inform the Team Lead.
- The Team Lead should involve all VEs present in assessing the situation. If the team determines cheating has occurred, terminate the exam immediately and record a failing grade regardless of the applicant's score at that point.
- Do not confiscate original documents. Make a copy and include it with the session materials submitted to SANDARC.
- The VE team's role is to document and report, not to penalize. Any final determination of guilt rests with the FCC.
- Report all confirmed cheating incidents to SANDARC immediately at vec@sandarc.org. Any other misconduct by an applicant or VE that cannot be resolved at the team level should also be escalated to vec@sandarc.org or by calling (619)215-1886.

Accommodating Applicants with Disabilities

VE teams MUST accommodate applicants whose physical disabilities require a special examination procedure. [[§97.509\(k\)](#)] No applicant with a disability may be refused service. If the team is not prepared to provide a specific accommodation on a given date, offer an alternative session.

- For visually impaired applicants, exams may be read aloud. [ExamTools](#) can generate exams without figures/schematics for this purpose.
- For applicants with hearing impairment or group sensitivity, consider a separate room.
- If testing in the applicant's home is necessary, this is permitted as long as at least three SANDARC-accredited VEs are present in-person or remote.

Remote Testing

SANDARC supports remote exam sessions conducted via [ExamTools](#) combined with a video conferencing platform (Zoom, Google Meet, or any other suitable platform). Remote sessions follow the same FCC rules and SANDARC policies as in-person sessions, with the additional requirements in this section.

SANDARC POLICY

- All recording at SANDARC remote sessions is prohibited. Do not record the session, applicant IDs, exam screens, or any other session activity. This applies to all VEs and applicants.
- The one exception: still photos for the promotion of SANDARC are welcome, provided they never capture personal information (IDs, Form 605s, or exam screens) and are never used to monitor applicants or document suspected cheating.

VE Technical Requirements for Remote Sessions

- Working computer or laptop with a webcam, microphone, and speaker.
- Reliable internet connection.
- Zoom (or another agreed platform) is installed and tested before the session.
- Test your camera, microphone, and speaker before each remote session.

Applicant Technical Requirements for Remote Sessions

- Working computer, laptop, tablet, or phone with a webcam, microphone, and speaker. No headphones or earbuds are permitted.
- Reliable internet connection.
- Zoom (or agreed platform).

- Only one active monitor or screen. Additional monitors must be disconnected or covered.
- No virtual or blurred backgrounds.

Remote Session Procedures

- 1 Start the video conference early so VEs can convene before applicants arrive.
- 2 Verify the applicant's identity via camera by visually inspecting their photo ID. Do not record or photograph the ID.
- 3 Conduct a 360° slow camera pan of the room to verify no unauthorized materials are present. Check the desk, floor near the testing area, and walls for notes, posters, or whiteboards.
- 4 Verify the desktop is clear: only the computer, keyboard, mouse, one sheet of scratch paper, a writing instrument, physical calculators for remote exams are not authorized.
- 5 Have the applicant share their screen and open [ExamTools](#). Verify no unauthorized programs are running.
- 6 Instruct the applicant of the exam rules and begin the exam.
- 7 VEs will turn off cameras while the applicant is taking the exam; mute microphones unless speaking.
- 8 If the applicant looks away from the exam area repeatedly, warn them; further violations terminate the exam.
- 9 If the video connection drops please contact the team lead immediately. You can evict the applicant until they rejoin the video chat, or if the connection drop is too long you may need to invalidate the exam entirely!

Fees & Expense Reimbursement

IMPORTANT

SANDARC charges NO exam fees. All examinations are completely free of charge to all applicants. No fees may be assessed against any applicant for any SANDARC exam session.

SANDARC does not provide reimbursement to VE teams for any session-related expenses. All costs associated with running a SANDARC exam session are the responsibility of the team. SANDARC may provide materials to teams as non-reimbursable expenses but these will be limited in scope and at the discretion of SANDARC.

FCC APPLICATION FEE

All applicants for a new license must pay a mandatory \$35 fee directly to the FCC. Applicants will receive an email from the FCC with payment instructions after SANDARC submits their session data. The payment link is <https://apps.fcc.gov/cores/paymentFrnLogin.do> and the fee must be paid within 10 calendar days or the FCC will dismiss the application.

Certificates of Successful Completion of Examination (CSCEs)

What Is a CSCE?

A CSCE must be issued to every candidate who passes one or more exam elements. It documents the element(s) passed and the license class earned. **ExamTools** generates and emails the CSCE automatically when the session is finalized and VEs sign electronically.

A CSCE is valid for 365 days from the date of issue, or until the FCC updates the applicant's ULS record, whichever comes first.

Operating Authority From a CSCE

SITUATION	OPERATING AUTHORITY
New applicant (previously unlicensed) who passes exam	NO transmitting authority. Must wait until a license grant appears in the FCC ULS database.
Expired licensee who passes exam	NO renewed privileges from the CSCE alone. Must wait for FCC ULS to show an active license.
Currently licensed applicant who earns an upgrade	May operate under the new (higher) license class privileges immediately, using a temporary identifier appended to their call sign.

Temporary identifiers for upgrades (appended after the call sign):

- **/KT** : Novice upgrading to Technician
- **/AG** : Technician upgrading to General class privileges
- **/AE** : General or Advanced upgrading to Amateur Extra class privileges

Completing the CSCE

- ExamTools populates and distributes the CSCE automatically for electronic sessions.
- Three VEs must sign the CSCE
- The applicant must sign the CSCE in the presence of a VE.
- Give the applicant their copy of the CSCE immediately. Advise them to retain it as permanent proof of exam credit.
- The team retains a copy for its records.

Pre-1987 Technician "Paper Upgrade" to General

An applicant who holds a currently valid Technician license that was originally issued before March 21, 1987 is entitled to General class credit without taking Element 3. They must appear in person at a VE session with valid proof of the pre-1987 license. Issue a CSCE showing General class earned and process a Form 605. No exam is required for this credit.

Felony Question Information

- If an applicant marks yes on the felony question these are the steps for them to proceed with so their application can be reviewed by the FCC properly.
- It is not appropriate for any VE within SANDARC to ask about the circumstances regarding the felony the applicant has indicated yes to on the 605, it is only allowable to explain the process of submitting the statement. An applicant may offer up details of their information, but it is not in the place of any VE to dig further into that information. Any deviation from this policy that is reported to the VEC will result in SANDARC placing the VE under review for possible revocation of their accreditation.
- After a session is submitted with an applicant that marks yes to the felony question the applicant has a 14-day period to submit a statement to the FCC about why he or she believes they should be granted a license.
- There are no set guidelines of information that need to exist in the explanation but some useful stuff would be:
 - List all felony charges of which you were convicted (this part is mandatory)
 - A detailed description of the conduct that resulted in the conviction or guilty plea, including time and place
 - The date of the conviction or guilty plea
 - The punishment that was imposed, and whether the sentence has been completed, or the applicant is still under any restriction or condition resulting from the conviction or guilty plea
 - Any efforts taken to remedy the wrongs committed and ensure that the applicant will not engage in such conduct in the future.

Steps for Applicant

- 1 Applicant will need to find their application number as it **MUST** be included in the statement to the FCC and it can be found [here](#)

- 2 Applicant will need to email their explanation to attach605@fcc.gov.
- 3 Wait for the FCC to make a decision....There is no set minimum or maximum amount of time they can take to make this determination so sit back and wait.

Post Session Information

After the Session: Submission & Records

Submitting to SANDARC

SANDARC POLICY

- Submit the VEC Archive file generated by [ExamTools](#) to vec@sandarc.org as soon as possible after the session concludes.
- Include any supporting documents (e.g., element credit evidence) in the same email.
- If you encounter any issues with [ExamTools](#) or submission, contact vec@sandarc.org or call (619)215-1886 immediately but for the fastest response you should use the SANDARC Discord.
- The FCC requires session records to be retained by the VEC for at least 15 months. [[§97.519\(b\)\(3\)](#)] SANDARC retains submitted session records accordingly.
- Teams must retain their own copies of session documents until SANDARC confirms the session has been received and processed. If session records are lost, retained copies allow the session to be reconstructed without applicants having to retest.

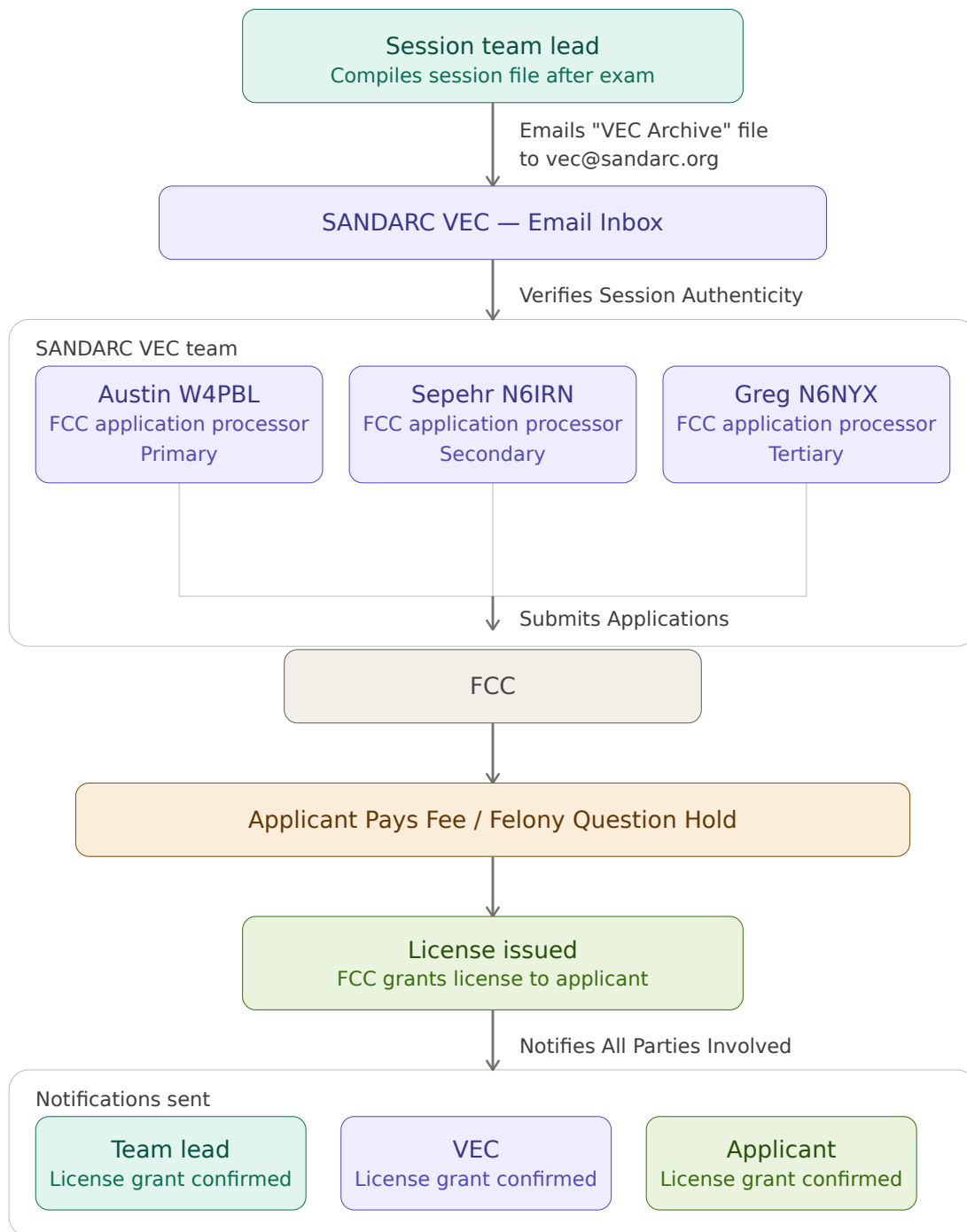
What to Send

- VEC Archive file from [ExamTools](#) (required for all sessions) (DO NOT OPEN THE ARCHIVE FILE FROM EXAMTOOLS)
- Copies of any element credit documents reviewed at the session (expired license copies, prior CSCEs)
- Notes on any scoring overrides or unusual circumstances

After completing the session in [ExamTools](#), the Team Lead should:

- 1 Click "Finish Session" in [ExamTools](#) to finalize all paperwork.
- 2 Download the VEC Archive file.
- 3 Email the VEC Archive file and any supporting documents to vec@sandarc.org.
- 4 Sit back, relax and enjoy the services of The Coolest VEC!

Session Submission Process



Start A Team

Becoming a SANDARC Volunteer Examiner

FCC VE Qualifications (47 CFR 97.509(b))

To qualify as a Volunteer Examiner under FCC rules you must:

- Be 18 years of age or older
- Hold a valid General, Advanced, or Amateur Extra class Amateur Radio license
- Never have had your Amateur Radio license suspended or revoked

VE Eligibility by License Class

VE LICENSE CLASS	MAY ADMINISTER
General Class	Element 2
Advanced Class	Elements 2 and 3
Amateur Extra Class	Elements 2, 3, and 4

Those holding a Technician class license may not take part in administering or grading exams. However, they may assist with tasks such as responding to inquiries, setting up the exam room or printing exam materials.

Examiner Accreditation Process

SANDARC does not directly recruit examiners as accreditation is gained through existing teams. Team leads are responsible for identifying and recruiting willing, qualified amateurs to join their team at their sole discretion.

To add a new examiner to your team:

- 1 Have the prospective examiner fill out the current accreditation form.
- 2 Submit the form to vec@sandarc.org

 NOTE

Please encourage your new team members to fill out the form digitally. Some handwriting really does hurt our eyes 😞.

We process accreditation forms within 24 hours (usually much, much faster!). In the extremely unlikely case that we do not meet that deadline, kindly send us a follow-up email. Team leads will receive an email as soon as their new examiner has been accredited. New examiners may have to wait up to four hours before [ExamTools](#) reflects their SANDARC credentials and allows them to be added to SANDARC sessions.

 NOTE

Each team is issued an accreditation form that is digitally unique to that team. Please do not use forms that are not issued to your team. If you need a copy of your team's accreditation form, kindly let us know.

Deactivations

We reserve the right to deactivate examiners for the following reasons:

- Not having participated in a session in two years
- Unable to be reached via email (bounced email / no contact info)
- Canceled or expired licenses

Inactive examiners wishing to be reactivated should contact us at vec@sandarc.org.

 NOTE

Deactivation does not constitute disaccreditation. Inactive examiners are still deemed accredited. However, they are not permitted to participate in sessions and cannot be added to sessions on [ExamTools](#).

Verifying Accreditation Status

Team leads can determine whether a given person is an active (or inactive) SANDARC examiner using the below methods:

- Use the `/lookup` command on our Discord server.
- Try adding them to a SANDARC session on [ExamTools](#) (may have a four-hour lag for new examiners)
- Using the verification link on the certificate of accreditation issued to examiners.

Updating Your Examiner Records

SANDARC automatically syncs its records with the ULS Database. Therefore, you do not need to notify us for changes to the following items:

- Name
- Callsign
- License Class
- Zip Code

If your VE certificate needs to be updated as well, we will send you a new one automatically!

Examiners must always maintain a valid email address on record with the VEC. If your email address needs to be updated, please let your team lead know so that they can notify us accordingly.

Where to Start?

Organizations wishing to host an Amateur Radio exam session should delegate one of their members as the VE Team Lead. The Team Lead will serve as the main point of contact between SANDARC, examiners, and your organization.

Your designated team lead should then contact SANDARC VEC via email at vec@sandarc.org on behalf of your organization. We reserve the right to accept or deny requests to start a new team at our sole discretion.

SANDARC favors in-person teams that are attached to a club, organization, or a recurring tech-related event.

Create Your Team on ExamTools

Upon approving your request, you will be asked to provide some information about your team on [ExamTools](#). If you are new to [ExamTools](#), please refer to [ExamTools documentation](#) to get set up with their platform. If you are migrating an existing team to SANDARC, there is no need to create a new team. Simply add SANDARC to your existing team. SANDARC only accepts sessions that are conducted via [ExamTools](#) AND by the team that we have on file.

NOTE

Please bear in mind that SANDARC only accepts sessions that are run through the teams we have on file. In other words, SANDARC team leads are strictly forbidden from delegating their team lead privileges to a team that SANDARC has not approved.

IMPORTANT

All SANDARC Teams are required to add Austin Smith, W4PBL, to their team on [ExamTools](#) as a co-owner. Failure to do so will result in immediate suspension.

Information We Need About Your Team

- **Team Lead:** This is the person in charge of communicating with the VEC. Furthermore, the team lead is also responsible for conducting the exam session, ensuring the examiners are well taken care of, and that the exam session adheres to [FCC Part 97 rules](#) and SANDARC policies.
- **Co-Lead:** Your co-lead can be one or more SANDARC VE's on your team who we may reach out to in case we are unable to reach the team lead. Usually, Co-Leads are the co-owners of your [ExamTools](#) team. Please note that co-leads are not granted team lead privileges and may not independently conduct exam sessions.
- **Team Email Address:** This email will be shared with potential applicants looking for an exam session in your area. It could be the team lead's email address or an email address belonging to your organization. SANDARC will not use this email address to contact your team as we use the team lead's personal email address for that purpose.
- **Zip Code:** This zip code corresponds to the approximate location of where your exam sessions are held.